

E X T R A C T S

"The Indian vote and election results have been negative. I have my doubts if the country will ever recover from this shock. That is why I keep telling our people not to play with the fires of adult voting for elections to assemblies. They will only burn their fingers and themselves in the process too."

—On the 1967 general elections in India and the implications of universal adult suffrage

"We must get East Pakistan ministers to examine if there is any practical solution. I doubt if this will bear any fruit as the Bengalis have no stomach for self-criticism nor for listening to the truth about themselves. People who do not have these qualities cannot recognise their maladies, let alone cure them."

—On dealing with Bengalis in East Pakistan (Bangladesh)

"When thinking of the problems of East Pakistan, one cannot help feeling that their (Muslim Bengalis) urge to isolate themselves from West Pakistan and revert to Hindu language and culture is close to the fact that they have no culture and language of their own, nor have they been able to assimilate the culture of the Muslims of the sub-continent, by turning their back on Urdu. Further, by doing so they have forced two state languages on Pakistan. This has been a great tragedy for them and for the rest of Pakistan. They lack literature on the philosophy of Islam."

—On Bengali language and culture in East Pakistan

obtained divine wisdom about Pakistan after a 48-hour visit to Islamabad), who take an interest in India's neighbourhood, this book is important reading. It gives a graphic description of how Pakistan's rulers think, in their obsession to seek "parity" on every conceivable issue, with India. It also focuses attention on the dangers that a medium-sized country like Pakistan invites when it tries to exploit the Great Power differences for its own benefit. At the same time, one gets a good insight into the depth of the Persian-Arab rivalries in the Persian Gulf and the Middle East, and the biases of President Richard Nixon.

Reading Ayub's *Diaries*, one cannot help noting how an opinionated military ruler, supremely confident of his abilities and contemptuous of democratic institutions, brought about his own downfall and ruination to his country. His military alliance with the US earned the wrath of the Soviet Union and proved of little avail during and after the 1965 conflict. His successor Yahya Khan brought disaster on Pakistan by helping forge a US-China partnership directed against the Soviet Union, forcing a seemingly friendly Soviet Union to turn hostile to Pakistan yet again. Ayub's suspicions about Afghanistan bordered on paranoia. Nearly four decades after his ouster, we are witnessing a downturn in the fortunes of yet another Pakistani military ruler, who shows a similar contempt for democratic institutions and claims to be an ally of the US even as he permits Taliban leaders to seek haven in his country and kill American and NATO soldiers in Afghanistan. Reading Ayub's *Diaries*, one wonders if Pakistan's military rulers ever learn anything from history. ■

NEW RELEASES



THE OTHER SIDE OF JUSTICE
by JUSTICE S.S. SODHI
Hay House
Price: Rs 395
Pages: 315

The former chief justice of Allahabad High Court questions the credibility of India's judiciary, recounting incidents of 'judicial politics', punishment posting of judges and lack of transparency in courts.



EQ AND LEADERSHIP
by P.T. JOSEPH, S.J.
Tata McGraw-Hill
Price: Rs 450
Pages: 385

The seminal work explains the relationship between emotional intelligence and effective leadership with the help of case studies and analysis of profiles of leaders like Richard Nixon and Jawaharlal Nehru.



OUR GANDHI: WHY HE DID WHAT HE DID
by M.S. RAO
Masara House
Price: £9.99; Pages: 581

The book attempts to "freshen up our Gandhi", exploring his ever-relevant values. A chapter on Nathuram Godse's defence, a comparison between Gandhi and Jesus and amusing tidbits make for interesting reading.